Goodbye Party for Miss Pushpa T.S.

By Nissim Ezekiel

About the Poet: Nissim Ezekiel

- Born in 1924, Mumbai, India.
- Foundational figure in Indian English poetry.
- Explores themes like postcolonial identity, everyday life, Indian culture.
- Notable Works:'Night of the Scorpion', 'The Patriot', etc.

Friends,
our dear sister
is departing for foreign
in two three days,
and
we are meeting today
to wish her bon voyage.

You are all knowing, friends,
What sweetness is in Miss Pushpa.
I don't mean only external sweetness
but internal sweetness.
Miss Pushpa is smiling and smiling
even for no reason but simply because
she is feeling.

Miss Pushpa is coming
from very high family.
Her father was renowned advocate
in Bulsar or Surat,
I am not remembering now which place.
Surat? Ah, yes,
once only I stayed in Surat
with family members
of my uncle's very old friend-
his wife was cooking nicely…
that was long time ago.

Coming back to Miss Pushpa
she is most popular lady
with men also and ladies also.

Whenever I asked her to do anything,
she was saying, 'Just now only
I will do it.' That is showing
good spirit. I am always
appreciating the good spirit.

Pushpa Miss is never saying no.
Whatever I or anybody is asking
she is always saying yes,
and today she is going
to improve her prospect
and we are wishing her bon voyage.
Now I ask other speakers to speak
and afterwards Miss Pushpa
will do summing up.

Introduction to the Poem

- 'Goodbye Party for Miss Pushpa T.S.' is a humorous poem, for its commentary on Indian English.
- Reflects everyday speech and cultural nuances, indianisms and other colooquial elements.

Poem Structure

- Free verse with no specific rhyme scheme or meter.
- Use of colloquial language and everyday speech.
- Tone is kept Humorous, light-hearted.

Themes of the Poem

- Indian English:Humorous effect through the use of Indian English.
- Reflects the everyday speech of many Indians.
- Social Commentary: English proficiency as a marker of social status in India.
- Postcolonial critique on the obsession with going abroad and speaking English.

Character of the Speaker

- Speaker's Traits: Jovial, well-meaning but lacks public speaking skills.
- Errors and tangents add humor.
- Humor in the Poem

Analysis of Key Passages

- Key Excerpts: Analyze humorous elements and social commentary.
  (Miss Pushpa is coming from very high family)
- Discuss how these reflect the speaker's character and cultural context.
  (refers to Ms Pushpa as a ‘dear sister’)

Language and Style

- Colloquial Language: Importance in keeping the tone light and humorous.
- Reflects realistic speech patterns.
  (Miss Pushpa is smiling and smiling)
- Line Breaks and Punctuation.
  (Surat? Ah, yes,)

Questions for the Class:

- What do you find most humorous about the poem?
- Discuss the significance of English language proficiency in the context of the poem.

Provide appropriate expression

Goodbye Party for Miss Pushpa TS

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What sweetness is in Miss Pushpa

Miss Pushpa is smiling and smiling

Miss Pushpa is coming from very high family

I am not remembering now which place

my uncle’s very old friend-his wife was cooking nicely

Conclusion

- Summary:key themes, humor, and social commentary.
- Ezekiel’s use of everyday language to convey deeper messages.

Thank You